

COMPLAINT NUMBER: 2026-0329566

WARRANT NUMBER: GS1113602

PROSECUTOR: Zachary D Wilbanks

DEFENDANT: James W Braden

VICTIM: Mericea Darlene Gooch

STATE OF TENNESSEE, COUNTY OF DAVIDSON

AFFIDAVIT

Assault, Domestic, Bodily Injury 3rd or more - enhanced

39-13-111

Personally appeared before me, the undersigned, **[Select one]** ☒ Commissioner ☐ Metropolitan General Sessions Judge, the prosecutor named above and made oath in due form of law that **[Select one]** ☒ he ☐ she **[Select one]** ☐ personally observed ☒ has probable cause to believe that the defendant named above on 05/28/2026 in Davidson County, *did unlawfully* push the victim causing her to fall into another object and cause bruising to the breast area

and that *the probable cause is as follows*:

On 5/28/2026, police were flagged down at the intersection of Lewis St. and Perkins St. by the victim, Mericea Gooch, who appeared visibly upset. The defendant, James Braden, was approximately 50 feet behind her, calling her derogatory names. Ms. Gooch initially stated that she just wanted Mr. Braden to leave her alone. Ms. Gooch stated that she and Mr. Braden previously dated and lived together before separating approximately one month ago. Both Ms. Gooch and Mr. Braden appeared visibly intoxicated.

Ms. Gooch stated that she was in town visiting a friend when she and Mr. Braden began speaking. It is unclear who initiated the conversation. Ms. Gooch ended up bringing McDonald's to Mr. Braden. Sometime afterward, Mr. Braden became upset with her and began acting disrespectfully toward her. She then walked away and flagged down police.

Ms. Gooch later stated that the defendant pushed her the previous day at a nearby laundromat, possibly located at 975 Murfreesboro Pike, causing her to fall into a dryer and bruise her left breast. Ms. Gooch showed police a large bruise on her left breast. Mr. Braden initially stated that he had not been around Ms. Gooch the previous day, but later stated that he had only been around her at his house after she showed up unexpectedly. Mr. Braden then stated that he never touched Ms. Gooch.

Mr. Braden has an extensive domestic assault arrest history, while Ms. Gooch has never been arrested in Davidson County for domestic assault. Due to the victim's injury, her statements, and Mr. Braden's domestic assault history, he was determined to be the primary aggressor and was taken into custody without incident. Ms. Gooch stated she does not wish to prosecute for the assault.

Prosecutor: Zachary D Wilbanks 100005223

ARREST WARRANT

Information on oath having been made, that on the day and year aforesaid, and in the County aforesaid, the offense

of Assault, Domestic, Bodily Injury 3rd or more - enhanced E FELONY, as aforesaid, has been committed and charging the defendant thereof, you are therefore commanded, in the name of the State, forthwith to arrest and bring the defendant before a judge of the Court of General Sessions of Davidson County, Tennessee, to answer the above charge.

Sworn to and subscribed before me on 05/28/2026 23:31:28 .

Timothy M Lee

Judge of the Metropolitan General Sessions Court/Commissioner

If the defendant's charge is dismissed, a no true bill is returned by a grand jury, the defendant is arrested and released without being charged with an offense, or the court enters a nolle prosequi in the defendant's case, the defendant is entitled, upon petition by the defendant to the court having jurisdiction over the action, to the removal and destruction of all public records relating to the case without cost to the defendant.

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